Coin Cabinet: what the test users said

Three pretend users tried the app (session 22). Each one wrote an app-store-style review, a list of what worked, what confused them, and a wish list. This is all of it in one place. Prepared 3 Nov 2026 for the app owner.

REVIEW 1
First-time collector
★★★★☆
4 of 5

REVIEW 2
The heir (inherited box)
★★★☆☆
3 of 5

REVIEW 3
Coin-show seller
★★★★☆
4 of 5

How to read this: **green** = what they liked, **red** = what confused them or broke, **blue** = what they wished for. Tests were run by a script on a test computer with no internet, so live metal prices, photos, real touch feel, printing and file saving were **not** tested.

The big picture

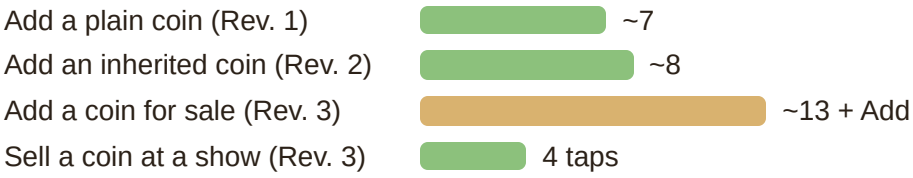
Problems that came up again and again

Problem	1 Collector	2 Heir	3 Seller
Silver/gold look worthless (or totals are low) until a metal price is typed in, and nothing says so	●	●	○
Many coins get no Red Book value (face value or melt shown quietly) — check against your Red Book	●	●	●
Words a newcomer won't know (Melt value, Red Book, Kept in, Raw...)	●	●	○
Locked "Fill in from photos · Coming soon" box on every Add coin form	●	●	●
Important fields hidden inside folded sections (Source, fees, tax, payment)	○	●	●
No quick way to add the next coin ("Add another")	●	○	○

Red dot = that reviewer ran into it.

⚠ **One real bug found (Review 3):** a coin's ID changes the first time the app is reopened (MD-001 became MD-002; the number 001 is used up). It matters if you write IDs on coin flips. It is already on the Fix list in PLAN.md for a quick Sonnet fix.

Effort per coin (taps and entries counted by the testers)



What all three liked

- Adding by typing the coin name: search, pick, year, mint mark, grade. The mint list only shows mints that really struck that coin.
- Empty pages tell you what to do next.
- Coin IDs, Red Book value on the coin page, Hide values button, backup reminder.
- Seller tools (Shows, Sales Reports) stay out of the way until Seller Mode is on.

Top wishes, combined

1. **Be honest about missing prices:** ask for the metal price on the first silver/gold coin; warn when totals are low; say "No Red Book value for this date/grade" instead of quietly using face value.
2. **Fix the changing coin ID.**
3. "Add another" after saving; plain-words help on tricky words.
4. Inherited coins: a "Value when inherited" field, and a way to mark one For sale.
5. Sellers: printable price list, a default sale date from the show, fees/tax visible when a show is picked.
6. Hide or shrink the locked photo-fill box.

Review 1: The first-time collector ★★★★☆

A new collector added 10 US coins (2 Morgans, Peace, Walking Liberty, Standing Liberty, Mercury, Roosevelt, Buffalo, Jefferson, Lincoln wheat), then opened every menu page, Options, New album and Hide values.

> *"Adding a coin by typing its name is quick: search, pick, year, mint mark, grade, Add. The mint mark list only shows the mints that really struck that coin, which I liked. Each coin page shows its ID, mintage and a Red Book value. Then I hit a wall: my silver Walking Liberty half showed $0.50 and Home said Melt value $0.00. I almost thought the app was broken. Four stars because the basics are great once you know where things are."*

✓ What was useful

- About 7 taps per coin. Metal and ounces fill in by themselves (Morgan: silver, 0.77344 oz).
- Coin IDs, mintage, "Suggested if you list it", eBay sold link.
- Empty pages say what to do next. Hide values, backup reminder, Coin Value page by type.
- Shows and Sales Reports hidden until Seller Mode is on.

× What was confusing or broke (no crashes)

1. **Silver coins look nearly worthless until a silver price is entered.** Home showed value $570, Melt $0.00. Silver coins showed face value. Nothing says "face value only".
2. **Only 3 of 10 coins got a Red Book value** (the Morgans and the Peace). Others fell back to face value or "—" (1936 Buffalo F-12 $0.05; 1950-D Jefferson MS-63 $0.05; 1930 Standing Liberty VG-8 "—"). *Check against your Red Book; nothing was guessed.*
3. "Tap to enter metal prices" opens Options, but Spot prices is still folded: one more tap.
4. After saving, adding the next coin means + then US coin again. No "Add another".
5. Words a newcomer won't know: Melt value, Spot prices, Red Book, Kept in, Seller Mode, Share a snapshot, Photo fill (API key).
6. The locked photo-fill box sits at the top of every Add coin form and mentions an "AI key".
7. New album form puts a very long coin-type list before brand and album number.

★ Wish list (ranked)

1. Ask for or fetch the metal price on the first silver/gold coin; label face-value fallbacks.
2. "Add another" button after saving.
3. Say "No Red Book value for this date/grade"; review the pricebook gaps.
4. "Tap to enter metal prices" opens Spot prices already unfolded.
5. Plain-words help for tricky terms.
6. Hide or shrink the locked photo-fill box.
7. Album form: brand and number first, coin-type list later.

Not tested: live metal prices, photos, real touch feel, backup/restore, Undo after delete, filling an album, selling.

Review 2: The heir ★★★☆☆

A pretend heir who inherited a box of coins added 10 coins (1881-S Morgan MS-63, 1922 Peace VF-20, and eight with unknown grade), marked each Source as inherited, opened every page, entered a silver price and built the Insurance Report.

> *"I inherited my uncle's coins and wanted a list for the insurance company. The app understood right away that these were inherited: each coin says 'Inherited · do not sell', and the insurance report has my uncle's estate name, totals, a list of every coin and a note that it isn't an appraisal. That part is great. But my report said the whole box was worth $121, when my silver coins are worth far more, and I only found out because I typed in a silver price. Nothing told me to. I also couldn't see how to say 'I'd like to sell these eventually'. Three stars: the report is nearly what I need, but I wouldn't trust its total yet."*

✓ What was useful

- Source has an "Inherited" choice: hides Paid and gain math, keeps the coin out of Cost and Gain on Home.
- About 8 taps per coin; an unknown grade just stays "Raw".
- Insurance Report: owner name, date, coin IDs, grade, Red Book 2026 label, totals by type, silver/copper weight, and an "owner's estimates, not a professional appraisal" note.
- "Choose coins" makes a report for part of the box. Home asks for a backup right away.

× What was confusing or broke (no crashes)

1. **The report's total is too low until a silver price is entered, and nothing says so.** $121.32 before; $146.16 after typing silver at $30.
2. **Only 2 of 10 coins got a Red Book value.** The other eight fell back to face value (a silver Franklin half shows $0.50). Ungraded coins don't say "add a grade to get a value". *Check against your Red Book.*
3. "Paid $0.00" on the report for inherited coins, and nowhere to record what a coin was worth when inherited.
4. No way to mark an inherited coin For sale ("Inherited coins can't be set to For sale").
5. "Source" is inside the folded "Purchase details", so an heir may never find it.
6. Unknown words: Raw, Do not sell (sounds like an order), Melt value, Red Book, Mint mark, Holder, Kept in.
7. Locked photo-fill box again.
8. "Create report" closed the pop-up with no message (probably only the test's missing file saving; check on a real phone).

★ Wish list (ranked)

1. Make the report honest: warn when a silver/gold price is missing.
2. Say "No Red Book value" and "Add a grade to get a value".
3. A "Value when inherited" field (and date), optional on the report.
4. Let an inherited coin be marked For sale without losing its inherited label.
5. Ask "Did you inherit these?" at the top of Add coin.
6. Plain-words help. 7. Hide the locked photo-fill box.

Not tested: saving the report as a file, printing/PDF, photos, touch feel, live prices, backup/restore, Undo, selling an inherited coin, filling an album, CSV import, hundreds of coins.

Review 3: The coin-show seller ★★★★☆

An amateur seller typed metal prices, turned on Seller Mode, added 5 coins as Business stock for sale, built a Dealer case (2 rows of 4), created a 3-day show with $470 of costs, sold 3 coins (cash, and card with fees and sales tax), returned the unsold ones, and read Home, For Sale list, the Show page and Sales Reports.

> *"Finally an app that thinks like a table at a show. I put my coins in a 'Show case', the app switched them to For sale and suggested prices, I tapped one and sold it in three taps with the price already filled in, and at the end it showed what the weekend actually made after the table fee, gas and hotel. Sales Reports even has a tax-style summary. Four stars: three of my five coins got no suggested price at all, and the ID I wrote on a flip changed the next time I opened the app."*

✓ What worked well

- **Selling is fast:** open coin, Mark as sold, pick the show, Mark sold. The price is pre-filled, "Where" fills itself, and a live "Profit" line appears. Math checked by hand.
- Dealer case moves coins to For sale, remembers where each came from; "Return unsold coins" is one tap.
- Show page: sales, coin cost, fees, each show cost, profit (−$433.83 after $470 of costs) and the sales tax collected ($3.78, "isn't profit").
- Sales Reports by month/quarter/year and platform, a "Schedule C style" summary, printable page and CSV, "not tax advice" note.
- Business stock stays out of the personal collection totals.

× What was confusing or broke

1. BUG **A coin's ID changes the first time the app is reopened** (reproduced three times: MD-001 became MD-002). Needs a fix.
2. **3 of 5 coins got no suggested price:** 1942-D Mercury Dime XF-45, 1943 Walking Liberty Half AU-50, 1936-D Buffalo Nickel VF-20. *Check against your Red Book.*
3. **Two different "profit" numbers:** Home says +26.4% / $36.17 (before show costs); the show page says −$433.83. Both right, but confusing.
4. Sale date defaults to today, not the show's dates; a future-dated sale got no warning.
5. Fees, sales tax and payment method are hidden under "More details" on the sold form.
6. Dealer case needs rows and slots; the empty-field error message is vague.
7. No way to price many coins at once.
8. No printable price list or price tags for the booth.
9. Minor: Select screen stays open after moving; case list order differs from slot grid; type chips list every type on an empty collection; locked photo-fill box again.

★ Wish list (ranked)

1. Fix the changing coin ID.
2. Fill pricebook gaps / say "No Red Book value"; "Set asking price for all" in the case.
3. Printable price list or tags for the booth.
4. Sold form: default date to the show; keep fees/tax/payment visible when a show is picked.
5. Label Home's profit "before show costs".
6. Dealer case defaults (e.g. 2 rows of 6).
7. A "break-even" line on the show page. 8. Plain-words help.

Not tested: saving/printing reports, photos, touch feel, live prices, a Whatnot/eBay sale with shipping, Pricing options changes, Attendee role, Hide values at the table, backup/restore, Undo, hundreds of coins, offline use at a real show.